

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

This month in ALT:

This month in Geek Key we study the back of paintings, also known as versos, and what they teach us; in 1000 words we understand the geometry of different types of spider webs, and much more.



Updates for movies

The "fix it in post" approach for software and games is now spreading to other categories of products, including vehicles (Tesla) and movies (Cats). The question is, are the benefits of rolling out such "updates" really worth the effort?

<https://dgit.in/catsup>

WHAT'S NEW

How to beat South Korea's AI hiring robots

Consultants for young people are making a killing by providing advice on how to handle interview questions by AI for large companies in South Korea. The demand is fuelled by rampant youth unemployment and stiff competition. There are entire exam villages where the freshers are made to cram up information they would require for the test. A new segment of tutors are teaching the students how to beat interviews with AI, which can use facial recognition technologies to analyse the characters of students. One of the tricks is to "smile with your eyes" instead of forcing a smile with your mouth. While AI is being



incorporated into the hiring processes all around the world, the approach is particularly popular in South Korea because of the influence large

companies can exert over a job market. The AI systems judge participants on factors such as joy and fear, and put candidates through gamified tests to judge their personality and adaptability.

<https://dgit.in/aihrbot>

The Texas Instruments calculator monopoly

Texas Instruments has a monopoly in America when it comes to graphic calculators, required by students because of the curriculum. The design and cost of the devices have remained the same for over 20 years. The calculators cost roughly US \$100 each, which is well beyond what the students in the poorer schools can afford. The teachers in such schools are forced to pay for the calculators themselves, or the students tend

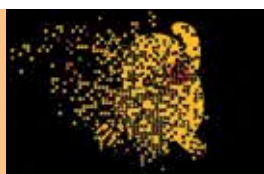
to skip classes. At the same time, students cannot be allowed to use more advanced devices such



as smartphones during tests, as there are advanced applications that can scan a problem, and

provide a step by step solution. Texas Instruments does not disclose the profit margin on the calculator. While analysts peg the profit margin at about 50 percent, ex employees claim that it could be as high as 80-90 percent. While Casio entered the market earlier, Texas Instruments seems to have used its relationship to the National Council of Teachers of Mathematics to gain a monopoly position.

<https://dgit.in/ticalc>



The lost emoji

The way that emoji has changed over the years means that some lose their meaning on different platforms, and emoji in older messages such as tweets might be replaced by newer representations that have different meanings, giving rise to "zombie emoji".

<https://dgit.in/lostemoji>



China decouples from GPS

With the Beidou constellation of navigation satellites approaching completion, China is decoupling from its reliance on the American Global Positioning System. 70 percent of the smartphones released in China are now compatible with Beidou.

<https://dgit.in/cnbeidou>



Bbq lighter jugaad

Scientists from Georgia Tech have hacked together a low cost electroporator, a high tech lab device that uses electricity jolts to temporarily open up cell walls, using barbecue lighters. The plans for the "electropen" are available online, along with a 3D printable casing.

<https://dgit.in/bbqepen>